

Employee Travel Policy

Business travel approval, booking, reimbursement, and evidence requirements

Classification: Internal - All Employees

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Intended audience	Employees, line managers, travel coordinators, and expense reviewers
Fixture status	Synthetic evaluation document

Document purpose

This controlled document provides realistic, structured content for the UC03 role-aware document retrieval and question-answering evaluation. It is not an operational company instruction.

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines how employees plan, approve, book, and claim reasonable costs for business travel undertaken on behalf of Northstar Manufacturing Oy. It applies to domestic and international trips paid directly by the company or reimbursed through an expense claim.

Normal commuting between an employee's home and regular workplace is outside scope. Relocation, long-term assignment, and customer-funded travel are governed by their applicable agreements. When a customer contract is stricter than this policy, the stricter rule applies.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Traveller	Provides a business purpose, selects reasonable options, retains evidence, and submits the expense claim promptly.
Line manager	Confirms business need, timing, destination, and budget before commitments are made.
Travel coordinator	Supports approved bookings and records itinerary changes when requested.
Finance Operations	Checks policy compliance, receipts, cost allocation, and required exception approvals.
Finance Director	Provides written pre-booking approval when the applicable hotel-rate limit must be exceeded.

3. Approval Before Booking

Employees must obtain approval from their line manager before booking transport or accommodation. The request must state the destination, business purpose, dates, expected cost, and cost centre. Approval of the trip does not automatically approve an exception to a specific spending limit.

Bookings must not be confirmed until the required trip approval and any applicable exception approval have been documented.

3.1 Changes after approval

A minor timetable change that does not materially increase cost may be recorded with the original approval. A change of destination, purpose, or budget owner requires renewed line-manager approval before the revised booking is confirmed.

4. Transport and Accommodation

4.1 Transport selection

Travellers should select a practical route that balances total cost, journey time, safety, and business needs. Public transport is preferred when it is reliable for the itinerary. Flexible tickets may be selected when meeting times are uncertain and the expected change cost justifies the fare difference.

4.2 Accommodation selection

Accommodation should be reasonably close to the work location or a practical public-transport route. The reimbursable rate includes the room charge and mandatory booking fees but excludes optional minibar, entertainment, wellness, and personal-service charges.

4.3 Hotel Limits

The maximum reimbursable hotel rate is **EUR 180 per night in Helsinki** and EUR 150 per night in Tampere. The applicable limit is based on the city where the employee stays, not the office responsible for the trip.

A rate above the applicable limit requires written approval from the Finance Director before booking.	
Situation	Required action
Rate is at or below the applicable city limit	Retain the booking confirmation and proceed under the approved trip request.
Only suitable room exceeds the city limit	Explain the reason and obtain written Finance Director approval before booking.
Rate increases after an unconfirmed reservation	Do not confirm until the applicable approval has been obtained.
Emergency change outside normal office hours	Choose a safe reasonable option, document the circumstances, and contact Finance Operations at the earliest opportunity.

4.4 Shared accommodation and extended stays

When two employees share a room, the expense claim must identify both travellers and must not duplicate reimbursement. A personal extension may be combined with a business trip only when the company does not incur additional cost and the business itinerary remains clear.

5. Meals and Incidental Expenses

The daily meal allowance for domestic travel is EUR 48 when meals are not otherwise provided. Where a host, conference, hotel package, or customer provides a meal, the traveller must record it in the expense claim so the allowance can be adjusted under the applicable payroll guidance.

5.1 Business meals

A business meal claim must identify the participants, organisations, business purpose, date, and itemised receipt. Alcohol and personal guest costs are not reimbursable unless separately permitted by an approved event budget.

5.2 Local transport and small expenses

Reasonable public-transport, taxi, parking, and baggage costs may be claimed when connected to the approved itinerary. The traveller must explain any taxi use when a lower-cost practical option was available.

6. Expense Claims and Evidence

Employees must retain the booking confirmation and receipt for the expense claim. Evidence should show the supplier, date, amount, currency, and purchased service. Card statements alone are not normally sufficient because they do not describe the item purchased.

Expense type	Minimum evidence
Flight or rail	Booking confirmation, itinerary, and receipt or invoice.
Hotel	Booking confirmation and final itemised hotel invoice.
Taxi or parking	Receipt plus business explanation where the purpose is not evident.
Business meal	Itemised receipt, participants, organisations, and business purpose.
Approved exception	Written approval attached to the claim together with the underlying receipt.

6.1 Missing evidence

If original evidence cannot be obtained, the traveller must provide a written explanation and any available secondary evidence. Finance Operations may return the claim for clarification or decline reimbursement when the business nature or amount cannot be verified.

7. Changes, Cancellations, and Exceptions

Travellers must cancel unused bookings promptly and retain cancellation records. Refunds must be credited to the same cost centre as the original expense. Non-refundable costs caused by a personal itinerary change are the traveller's responsibility unless the change was required for documented business reasons.

7.1 Exception documentation

An exception request should identify the policy rule, amount, business reason, alternatives considered, and required decision maker. The approval must be obtained before commitment whenever the policy states that pre-approval is required.

8. Traveller Safety and Disruption

Employees should follow company travel alerts and local safety instructions. During major disruption, personal safety takes priority over the lowest-cost option. The traveller should inform the line manager and travel coordinator as soon as practical and retain evidence of unavoidable changes.

9. Records, Review, and Contacts

- Expense documentation is stored with the approved claim under the company's finance-record controls.
- Finance Operations reviews this policy annually and records material revisions in the controlled-document register.
- Questions about ordinary claims should be directed to Finance Operations; line managers remain responsible for confirming business need.
- Suspected misuse, duplicate claims, or altered evidence must be reported through the established compliance channel.

Revision history

Version	Date	Summary
3.0	15 Jan 2025	Reorganised approval and evidence requirements.
3.1	1 Nov 2025	Clarified disruption and cancellation handling.
3.2	1 Jul 2026	Updated controlled-document metadata and examples.